do not remember me as disaster

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/39626985.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
Creator Chose Not To Use Archive Warnings

Category:
F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Bow & Glimmer (She-Ra)

Characters:
Glimmer (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Useless Lesbians, Magical Realism, Lesbian Disaster Adora (She-Ra), Angst, Hurt No Comfort, Lesbian Catra (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra) Needs a Hug, Catra is Bad at Feelings (She-Ra), catra is a forest spirit in this, adora summoned her by accident, Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, Sort of modern setting, they're at a timeless forest

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by phasmopunk

Summary

Catra only remembers a voice, as soon as she was created to protect the Woods of Bright Moon. She was angry, and lonely.

Adora loved being alone. So, she moved to the quiet woods outside of her town. Her plans: finish her memoir. She didn't expect to summon a chaotic forest spirit lost in time.

Notes

this was my best friend's prompt. i loved it. forest spirit!catra and human!adora that no one but her asked for.

See the end of the work for more notes

nor as the keeper of secrets

“Should we run?”

“I don’t know. Would you run with me?”

•————————•°•❀•°•————————•

Well, damn. Where the hell do you start a sad story?

Catra was a lonely creature. She would guard the woods, and when the shiny stars appeared in the skies, she would try and count them. There was an ancient song that said ‘love is hidden between the loneliest of stars’. So Catra looked for it, amazed. She looked for love, whatever it was. But she could never find it. She never knew exactly what love was, because there was no one around to explain it to her, anyway.

So, yes. Catra was lonesome. She had absolutely no idea how else to be, and it didn’t matter. She protected the Woods of Bright Moon, a small kingdom between the tallest mountains. Below the most isolated clouds. She guarded the forest with tenderness, but deep down, she was angry. Mostly because someone, a voice, once many Summers ago, told her ‘you must never leave this glade. You must never let anyone into the glade’. And she didn’t find it fair.

Usually, Catra slept soundly, because the last human to set foot in her lands had left her many centuries ago, running scared. Was she scary? She didn’t want to be. Or maybe that’s all she knew how to be. Terrifying to the eyes.

Alone. So utterly alone in the forest.

•————————•°•❀•°•————————•

Adora was so very tired of Bright Moon. She hated the sound of the cars, she hated the smoke that came out of the single train

that circulated the region of Etherea. She longed to get out of there. One day, at dawn approximately, she did.

She said goodbye to her friends, to the memories. She said goodbye to everything there was to say goodbye to. She took with her: favorite books, clothing for months, and the key to a shack in the middle of the woods that hadn't been touched in what felt like forever, if she judged the website pictures right. The owners, two married men - Bow's fathers - were kind enough to inform her that the woods didn't have good reception.

"You know there's like, this myth", Bow warned her. "About an entity that haunts the Old Forest."

"Do you really believe the things our nanas used to tell us?" Glimmer laughed at her boyfriend.

"It's supposed to be a dangerous creature, ok?" Bow frowned. "I never visited the shack because of them."

"Well, I think Adora will love it. It's almost as quiet as her."

"Haha." Adora rolled her eyes, finishing packing. "I'll be fine."

•————————•°•❀•°•————————•

Everything Catra knew about her world: it was very small, and very quiet. Sometimes, she saw smoke, and assumed it was fire. The same green-ish one she made with her hands when she needed to see better at night. Her eyes were well-accustomed to the lack of light, but sometimes it was too dark even for her. Too cold, even for her. So, she created fire.

Once, she thought she saw fire in her woods. She investigated from afar, and wondered if it was a foreigner she should scare away. It didn't feel like a foreigner, though, so she let it go.

She thought the stranger felt like the stars: unknown to her, but not misplaced. Whoever they were, they were supposed to be

there, for some reason. Even if Catra had no idea why. She would leave it at that, she wanted to leave it at that.

But like the stars, like everything that is beautiful, the stranger could not be left alone.

•————————•°•❀•°•————————•

Adora thought she heard strange noises, one night. She was alone since she moved in, something she was thankful for. She invited Bow and Glimmer to join her when Spring came, but now, she was by herself. And it was a marvelous experience.

She wrote in the morning. She was working on her new book. It was supposed to be a memoir, but sometimes, it felt more like a strange diary of silence. A song she couldn't remember the title of played in her head everytime she went to pick up her groceries by her door.

The woman was humming it, when she heard the strange noises.

"Hello? Is anyone there?" She tried, lifting one eyebrow.

No answer. She went back inside.

"Weird." She said to herself.

She woke up in the middle of the night, her bedroom windows fully open, wind punishing her face. Adora got up to close them, and felt like she was being watched. She frowned.

"Look, if there's anyone there, I'd rather you showed yourself." She spoke up. "Or I'll, I dunno, call the cops?"

"What are 'cops'?" A voice came from the darkness behind her. It was a husky, feminine voice.

"Hell, you scared the shit out of me." Adora put a hand on her heart.

“Hm. I apologize.” The girl covered in darkness said. “My name is Catra. I’m- I protect the woods.”

“You protect the woods? So you’re like, a forest guard?” Adora tried, uncertain.

“I think so.” The other woman replied. “Are you from the Kingdom?”

“No, I’m from. Hm. Bright Moon.” Adora tried to see the girl, despite the dark.

“Isn’t Bright Moon a kingdom?”

Adora laughed despite herself. “Sorry for laughing. I just never saw someone refer to good old Bright Moon like that.” She caught her breath. “It’s so pompous.”

A pause. The strange girl was confused.

“Okay. Well. Bright Moon hasn’t been a kingdom for I dunno, five centuries now?” Adora answered, more puzzled by the second. “Is this a joke? Did Bow send you to scare me?”

“I’m not trying to scare you.” The woman’s hand, without warning, produced a small green fire that lit up her face. She had brown skin, and long brown hair. “Hello. My name is Catra.” She had heterochromia, too. One eye was yellow, the other, blue. They were wide open and shone in the dark.
“Catra. That’s an… Unusual name.” Adora swallowed, nervous. The woman was beautiful. “I’m Adora. How did you get into my house again?”

“It wasn’t very hard. You leave your windows unlocked. I just… Pushed.” Catra frowned. “You seem scared. I already said I’m not trying to scare you.”

“Yeah, hm. Sorry. I’m just not used to having visits.”

Catra smiled, then. “Really? Me neither.”

•————————•°•❀•°•————————•

It took a while for Adora to believe Catra was, in fact, magical. That she had been summoned by Adora's singing. That the song was very old, and only sung inside the woods. Adora had no idea where she learned it, or why she sung it. But now, Catra visited her every morning, since Adora told the other woman she needed sleep.

"Sleep? I don't need sleep." Catra mocked.

"Well, I do, ok? And if you keep appearing in the middle of the night, I won't be able to sleep. So, just mornings, alright?"

Catra shrugged, seeming amused. "Alright. But you still have to tell me why you called me."

And Adora thought about it. Why did she summon Catra? According to the forest guardian, the song was sung by people who needed something. But what was it? Adora was happy, safe. She needed nothing at all. Still, Catra came back every day.

"What do you mean by 'trains'?" Catra asked. "The smoke is from the fire you make."

Adora grinned. "No, dude. The train makes the smoke, the chimneys make the smoke. Not actual fire. Humans can't produce green fire like you."

"That's dumb." Catra said. "Why can't you make green fire?"

"Dunno. But it would be wicked awesome."

Catra smirked. "You think I'm awesome?"

Adora blushed. "Oh, shut up."

•————————•°•❀•°•————————•

The problems started three months after Catra and Adora first met. Glimmer called Adora, and told her weird things had been happening. Water tastes different. Food was rotting fast. Trees were growing a day after being trimmed. Everything was out of place in Bright Moon.

“When did it start?” Adora asked, concerned.

“Three months ago, I think?” Glimmer assumed. “One day, all the bakeries just claimed they had mold in their bread. Very weird. We thought it was an isolated thing, but it’s been… Spreading. Like a plague.”

“That doesn’t make any sense.”

“I know! People are going insane. Crystals, rocks and minerals in general are starting to get smaller. Like something is cursing us.”

“Glimmer, that’s…”

“Impossible, I know.” She sighed. “All I’m saying is… Don’t come here, ok? Things are very, very strange right now.”

“Hm, ok.”

•————•°•❀•°•————•

One evening, Adora asked Catra if there was something she could do about Bright Moon.

“I only protect the forest, at least I think so.” Catra seemed lost in thought. “I’m not supposed to leave here, either.”

“Ok.” Adora stopped to think, for a bit. “Is there someone who protects the city?”

Catra shrugged. “I don’t think there are others like me.”

“But you’re not certain.”

“Well, how could I be?” She snapped. She sounded very angry. “All they told me was that I should stay here.”

“Sorry, I-”

“I ran away, ok?” Catra shouted, all of a sudden. “I wasn’t supposed to follow the song. At least, I don’t think I was.”

“What?” Adora prompted.

“I just-” Catra sighed, and sat on Adora’s bed. “I haven’t been telling you *everything*.”

“What do you mean?” Adora frowned. “There’s more?”

Catra nodded. “The forest didn’t always need protection, you know?”

saying we cannot waste time

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

Time was different for Catra. It was linear, but it was also very fast-paced. She jumped around centuries like it was nothing. But the last three months with Adora had been so slow. Maybe because she was out of the glade. Maybe because now, when she stared at the night sky, she only thought of Adora. She didn't have time to count.

Adora and her stupid blonde hair, stupid clothes so different from Catra's old tunic. Her easy smile and her way of telling stories. Catra almost forgot they weren't supposed to talk.

You see, Catra wasn't created out of nowhere. She was created because long ago, there was a war. Between two kingdoms; Bright Moon and Horde. And the goddess of the forest had been prohibited from interfering directly. So, she created her own soldier. A soldier who could protect the woods for her, forever. The battles always took place in the Woods of Bright Moon, and everytime, fire swept through the ground, and trees were endangered, and fauna was exposed. So, Shadow Weaver, the goddess of the forest, created Catra.

"Rise, Catra, the protector of the forest." A voice spoke. "I am your creator, and you will do as I say. You must never leave this glade. You must never let anyone into the glade. Not the glade, nor your heart. Your spirit belongs to the woods, and no one but me is allowed to let you leave."

"But what if someone needs me?" Catra whispered. She was scared. She couldn't remember her life before the voice. It was when she had been born.

"Love is hidden between the loneliest of stars", a different voice, a more familiar one, sang from afar. "You are supposed to find it, to

know who you are…”

“Who’s there?” Catra tried.

“Do not listen to the song,” Shadow Weaver shouted, and Catra paid attention. “Listen to me, child. You are a soldier, meant for this glade. Meant only for yourself.”

And after that, Catra only knew violence and fear. Anger. She protected the forest, but she knew there was someone out there who knew the lyrics to the same song as her. She just never heard them again.

“Until you hummed it.” Catra looked at Adora. “And. I knew it was you.”

Adora put her hand in front of her mouth. “How is that possible?”

“The person who sang the song so many centuries ago… I think they were looking for me, Adora. I think I had a life before the woods.” Catra was crying, now. “I think I was brought here by Shadow Weaver, but…”

“She didn’t… Create you.” Adora lifted her eyebrows. “Catra, do you really think it was me? Looking for you?”

Catra took Adora’s hand for the first time since they met. “Not you, but another version of you.”

“How is that possible?”

“Sing the song.” Catra asked.

“I… Can’t remember. I can’t remember how it goes.”

“Love is hidden between the loneliest of stars.” Catra started. “You are supposed to find it, to know who you are…”

“I will never stop looking, no matter how far…” Adora continued, instantly, her eyes closed, holding Catra’s hand tightly. “Time is no

measure, I'll sing as I go // My love for you is bigger than I'll ever know..."

"Please don't forget me, and together we'll grow." They finished. Together.

"Catra, I think I've been looking for you." Adora had tears in her eyes. "I always wanted to get away from Bright Moon. I thought it was because I liked to isolate myself."

Catra caressed her hand.

"But I was just looking for someone to be alone with." Adora was positively crying, now. "I think I was looking for you."

"When you sang the song," Catra began. "What were you thinking of?"

"Blue and yellow." Adora sighed. "Your eyes."

•————————•°•❀•°•————————•

"Adora, I think we need to run." Catra whispered. "I don't know if we're being watched, if…"

"But what about Bright Moon?" Adora reminded her. "My friends are facing some kind of invisible threat for months, and now we know it's because you left the glade."

"Yeah, but I wasn't supposed to *be there* in the first place. What if we had a life together, before Shadow Weaver threw me here? What if…"

"Catra, I know it's terrible, but… I think you've been keeping Bright Moon balanced. I think when you left the glade, it all went to hell."

"I can't go back!" Catra yelled. "I won't, ok? Now that I found you… I can't just…"

“I’d never asked you to go back!” Adora yelled back. “Maybe there’s another way, right?”

“Yeah”, Catra whispered. “Maybe there is.”

•————————•°•❀•°•————————•

That night, they slept together in Adora’s bed. Catra stared at Adora in the dark, and Adora stared back.

“Do you think we were lovers?” Catra caressed Adora’s hair.

Adora blushed a deep red. “I… Don’t know.”

“Would you like it?”

Adora opened her mouth to speak, but took a few moments. “It would be an interesting love story.”

Catra frowned. “Just… Interesting?”

Adora grunted. “What do you want me to say? That I think about kissing you all the time? That you’re beautiful, and amazing, and honestly way too close right now-”

Adora was being kissed. By the woman she had been looking for, without realizing it, for centuries. And then, she heard a voice, in the back of her head. She started crying shortly after.

“Are you ok?” Catra asked, drying her tears.

“Just kiss me, yeah?”

And she did. Many, many times.

•————————•°•❀•°•————————•

Catra had a dream about her old life, or at least, that’s what it seemed to be. In the dream, Adora wore similar tunics, and they walked around the woods hand in hand, in a mortifying silence.

“You know the goddess has her eyes on you”, Catra whispered to Adora.

The girl sighed. “Yes, I know.” Frowned, then. Her blue eyes were squinting. “She does want to turn me into her warrior, does she not?”

“She does.” Catra mumbled, helpless. She held Adora close to her, and gave her a deep kiss. “Should we run?”

“I don’t know. Would you run with me?” Adora grinned, sadly.

They both knew it was hopeless. In the next eclipse, Adora would be turned into a forest guardian, and they would be apart forever. But Catra had a plan - she would take her place. She would finish the war alone, and then, they could be free.

“I would go anywhere for you.” Catra said back.

•————•°•❀•°•————•

She woke up, scared. The bed was empty. Adora was gone.

“Adora!” Catra shouted as she left the cabin. But she knew exactly where she was. She made her way to the same place she had lived in for thousands of years. She found the glade.

She found Adora sitting in the middle of the clearing, and in her hand, a green-ish flame. She had tears in her eyes when she found Catra’s.

“What are you doing?” Catra yelled.

“You did the same for me, my love.” Adora whispered, trembling. “Many, many ages ago. But it was never supposed to be you, was it?”

“Please, Adora, we have to leave. We can run, we can…”

“Promise you’ll find me.”

“What? Of course I’ll-”

“Shadow Weaver will make me forget you, Catra. She told me that was the price.”

“Then why in hell did you accept?” There were tears rolling down her cheek.

“I’d rather forget you’re free, than remember you captive. Catra, I-”

“No. Don’t say it. Not now.” She closed her eyes. “Save it, ok? For when we’re both free.”

“Find a way to end the curse.” Adora asked. “Just… Fix it. For me.”

“Fuck,” Catra hissed. “I fucking hate this place. I can’t believe you’d do this without telling me.”

“Try to forgive me, yeah?” Adora laughed bitterly. “We have ages for that.”

When Catra opened her eyes, Adora was gone. So was the clearing.

•————•°•❀•°•————•

watching
you move slowly out of my bed
saying we cannot waste time
only ourselves.

Chapter End Notes

i hoped you liked it! oh, the angst. the fic was inspired on a poem by Audre Lorde called "Movement Song", that you can find here: https://www.poetryfoundation.org/poems/42581/movement-

song and you can find me here:
https://vampygoblin.tumblr.com/

End Notes

hope you liked my very unusual catradora fic. you can send me prompts on tumblr! vampygoblin.tumblr.com

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!